Making Logistics Work for Women

- Align state-level rules on women's night shifts
- Incentivise companies to hire and retain women
- Improve access to vehicles, smartphones and technology
- Build leadership pathways, mentorship and support networks
- Invest in safer, gender-responsive logistics infrastructure
- Strengthen workplace safety and POSH compliance
- Set measurable targets for hiring, retention and promotions
- Technology can reduce some of the physical demands of logistics



recognised for what they bring to the table.

The same shift in perception is visible in the experience of Chaitaly Mehta, Director, EKF Global Logistics Pvt Ltd, who has spent nearly three decades in logistics. A third-generation customs broker and second-generation freight forwarder, Mehta joined her family business 29 years ago. While her surname opened doors, it could not keep them open.

"Our industry is full of 'nepo kids', but only the toughest and the ones who work hard survive," she says. "Your name can only take you that far." It took her nearly two decades to become visible within the sector. "If you want to be recognised, you need to be visible. Your work will open doors, but you also have to talk about your work," she says. Her training was deliberately hands-on. Her father created no special path for her; she had to generate revenue, cover overheads and spend years working in the cargo complex. For a long time, she was the only woman regularly handling operations on the floor.

For her, visibility also meant participating in industry associations, writing, and leadership responsibilities. She now heads the Women's Wing of the Federation of Freight Forwarders' Associations in India, which has grown from four women in 2021-2022 to over 100 currently. Today, she sees more women taking seats on managing committees and running own businesses.

For Kruti Jobanputra, Director at JWC Logistics Park and JWR Logistics, understanding that ground reality became the foundation of her leadership. When she joined JWC Logistics Park in 2005, she started at the ground level in operations, a space then almost entirely male. "I believe starting from the ground level was one